

A**Label recovery**

Choose Pure-AE

NMI 0.609; ARI 0.406

kNN accuracy 0.784

No prior-induced boundary shift

B**Compact geometry**

Choose DPMM-Base

ASW 0.374; DAV 0.868

12/12 ASW and DAV wins

Accept concordance cost

C**Projection fidelity**

Choose DPMM-FM

DRE/LSE/DREX operating point

Flow smooths global manifold

Not a clustering optimum

D**Evidence-based suitability**